

MARINER

Hard-won and *well-* *planned*

A guide to helping you protect
and grow what's yours

You've built *momentum*.
You've made smart
decisions, stayed
focused and created
real progress.
So what comes next?

At some point, *financial
planning changes*.

It stops being about just earning and saving.
It starts being about *protecting, coordinating
and growing* what you've built.

Whether you're advancing in your career, managing a growing family, running a business or approaching a major transition, one reality stays constant: as your life evolves, your financial strategy must evolve with it.

And when you've reached this level, it's not about doing more. It's about making everything work together with greater intention, so what you've built can help take you further.

But for many successful professionals and entrepreneurs, the challenge isn't a lack of advice; it's a lack of coordination. You may have a CPA, an advisor and an estate planning attorney, but without alignment across those disciplines, even well-intentioned strategies can work against each other.

That's where complexity can begin to create risk. As financial decisions become more interconnected, even small disconnects can affect how well your overall strategy works together.

This guide explores how integrated planning is designed to help you preserve what you have, grow it with purpose and position you for what comes next at any stage.





Why so many *feel uncertain*

On average, Americans can answer only about half of basic financial questions correctly, which can make it harder to feel confident about the decisions that shape their future.¹



Uncertainty isn't always about income. It's often about complexity and the sense that decisions made today may not fully support tomorrow.

The sources of that complexity are familiar:

- Multiple accounts across institutions
- Changing tax exposure as income grows
- Rising healthcare and caregiving costs
- Supporting children's education or aging parents
- Market volatility and inflation
- Unclear long-term direction

The more progress you make, the more those decisions matter. And without a clear view of how they connect, small gaps begin to compound, shaping outcomes more than any single decision on its own.

From *accumulation* to *coordination*

Early on, financial progress follows a simple formula: *earn more, save more, invest more.*



57% of Americans say modern portfolios are more sophisticated and require more coordinated, professional guidance.²

But for wealth builders in their 40s and 50s, the questions become more complex:

- How do taxes affect investment decisions?
- How does today's withdrawal affect tomorrow's security?
- How does supporting family affect long-term independence?
- How does inflation reshape future purchasing power?



At this stage, the shift isn't just about making the right decision but understanding how each one works together within a broader strategy: *making more deliberate, connected decisions about how it's structured, accessed and sustained.*

The coordinated *wealth framework*

A coordinated approach to wealth is not about reacting to individual needs as they arise. It's about designing a strategy where *each part of your financial life works together* in a disciplined, consistent way over time, so your wealth can support not just where you are today, but where you're going.

Protect the foundation

Protection isn't about fear. It's about stability and clarity, ensuring that what you've built is structured to withstand change.

This includes organizing assets intentionally across accounts and entities, evaluating risk exposure across investments and insurance, understanding how taxes affect your overall strategy and planning for unexpected life events such as illness, career transitions or major family changes.

A strong foundation can help reduce disruption and enable flexibility when life doesn't go as planned.

Design sustainable income

As wealth grows, the focus shifts from simply accumulating assets to using them in a way that supports your life.

This means aligning investment strategy with income needs, coordinating withdrawals across account types to manage tax impact, maintaining appropriate liquidity for near-term goals and timing major financial decisions such as selling a business, exercising equity or funding education.

The goal is to generate income that's sustainable, efficient and aligned with how you want to live.

Transfer wealth intentionally

As your wealth grows, so do your responsibilities. You may be supporting family, contributing to causes you care about or preparing to pass assets to the next generation.

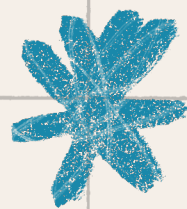
This includes structuring estate and trust strategies, defining how and when wealth is transferred, incorporating charitable giving in a thoughtful way and making your wishes clear for the legacy you want to create.

Intentional planning is designed to help ensure that what you pass on reflects not just your wealth, but your values.



Precision matters: small *decisions* *compound*

As financial decisions become more interconnected, the details begin to matter more. Small adjustments made consistently and deliberately can *have a meaningful impact* over time.



Investment strategy: *Growth with discipline*

A resilient investment plan doesn't chase returns; it balances them. This means diversifying across asset classes and time horizons, managing risk proactively rather than reactively, and adapting as your life, goals and market conditions evolve.

At roughly 3% average inflation over time, \$1 million today would need to nearly double over the next 20 years to maintain its value.³

Growth without discipline introduces risk. Discipline without growth can limit long-term potential. The balance is strategic and sustained.

Tax awareness: *Protecting long-term efficiency*

For high-income households, taxes can represent a significant share of incremental income, making tax strategy a critical part of long-term planning.⁴

A coordinated tax approach may include strategic Roth conversions during lower-income years, tax-loss harvesting aligned to investment strategy, timing of income events and charitable giving structures that improve both impact and efficiency.

Over time, these decisions can compound in meaningful ways, which may help preserve more of what you build.

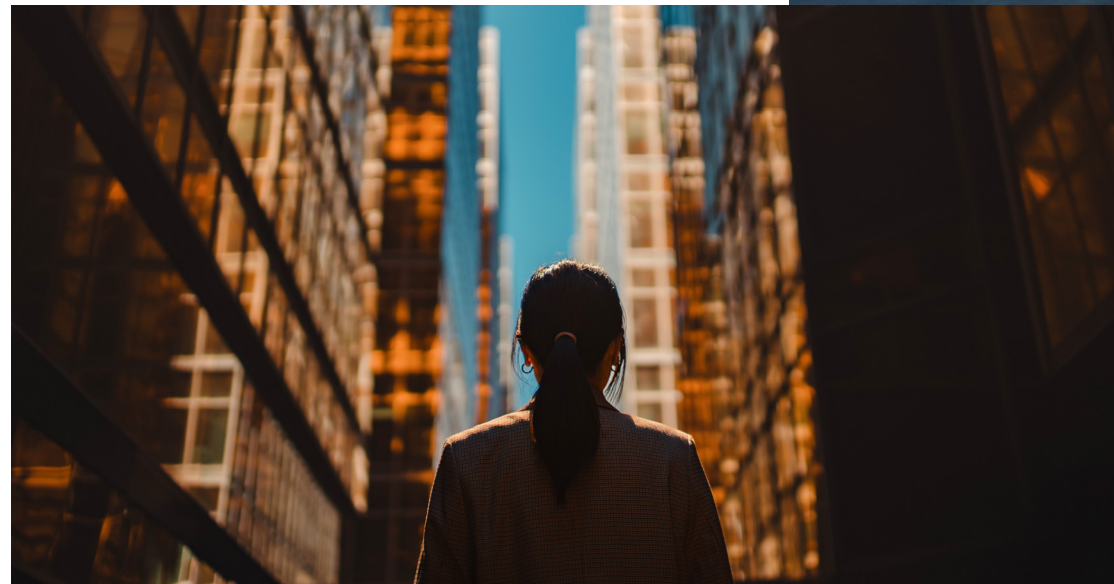
Staying *adaptive*

The most successful financial plans aren't necessarily the most complex; they're the most responsive. Regular reviews help catch warning signs before they become costly detours.

A practical way to stay on track is to regularly revisit a few key areas:

- Whether your current investment risk still aligns with your goals and time horizon
- How changes in income or tax law may affect your broader strategy
- Upcoming life events such as career transitions, new dependents or major purchases
- The true cost of your investments, including fees and expenses
- Patterns in your own decision-making that may introduce unintended risk

Even small adjustments in these areas can help keep your strategy aligned as circumstances change.



Planning is not a one-time event. It's a ***disciplined, ongoing process***. And over time, that discipline is just as important as the decisions themselves.

When financial decisions are made in isolation—*by different advisors, at different firms, with different information*—unintended consequences follow. Tax decisions may conflict with investment strategies. Estate plans may lag behind account structures. Giving may reduce liquidity needed elsewhere.



The advantage of integrated guidance

When they're coordinated, everything can begin to work together. Taxes align with investments. Investments align with goals. Goals align with both your life today and the legacy you want to create.

That alignment can bring clarity, and with it, greater confidence in the decisions you make.

People who have a financial plan tend to report greater confidence and clarity about their financial future than those who don't, highlighting the value of a more structured, coordinated approach.⁵

This is where integrated guidance makes a difference.

At Mariner, advisors have access to a coordinated team of in-house specialists, including tax, estate, trust, insurance and investment professionals, all working in your best interest.

That structure is designed to allow each decision to be evaluated from multiple perspectives, so you can make informed decisions without having to manage multiple disconnected relationships.

Whether you're continuing to build wealth or focused on preserving and passing it on, that level of coordination can help your strategy adapt to where you are and support where you want to go next.

Acting as a fiduciary means your best interest remains central to our recommendations.

You've worked hard to build what you have. ***Your strategy should reflect that.***

This is what *you've* *worked for*

You didn't build what you have by leaving things to chance. You made smart decisions, stayed focused and kept moving forward, even when it wasn't easy.



That same level of clarity and discipline should carry into how your wealth is managed today.

With the right team and structure in place, each decision can be evaluated in the context of your full financial picture. Mariner brings together experience, specialists and an integrated approach to help align every part of your financial life so it works together, not in silos.

You've built something meaningful.

Now you're ready for a more coordinated approach: one that helps protect what you've built, grow it with intention and put it to work in ways that support everything you want to do from here.

The next chapter is yours.
Let's build it right.

Start the conversation at mariner.com

¹ TIAA Institute / Global Financial Literacy Excellence Center, Personal Finance Index, 2024

² Charles Schwab, Modern Wealth Survey, 2025

³ U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Consumer Price Index (CPI); Mariner internal modeling, 2024

⁴ Tax Foundation, Summary of Latest Federal Income Tax Data, 2025 Update

⁵ Northwestern Mutual, Planning & Progress Study, 2025

This material is provided for informational and educational purposes only and should not be construed as investment, legal, or tax advice. The information presented is general in nature and may not be appropriate for every individual. Individuals should consult their professional advisors regarding their specific circumstances.

Investing involves risk, including the possible loss of principal. There is no guarantee that any investment or planning strategy will be successful.

For additional information about Mariner, including Form ADV and other important disclosures, please visit mariner.com.